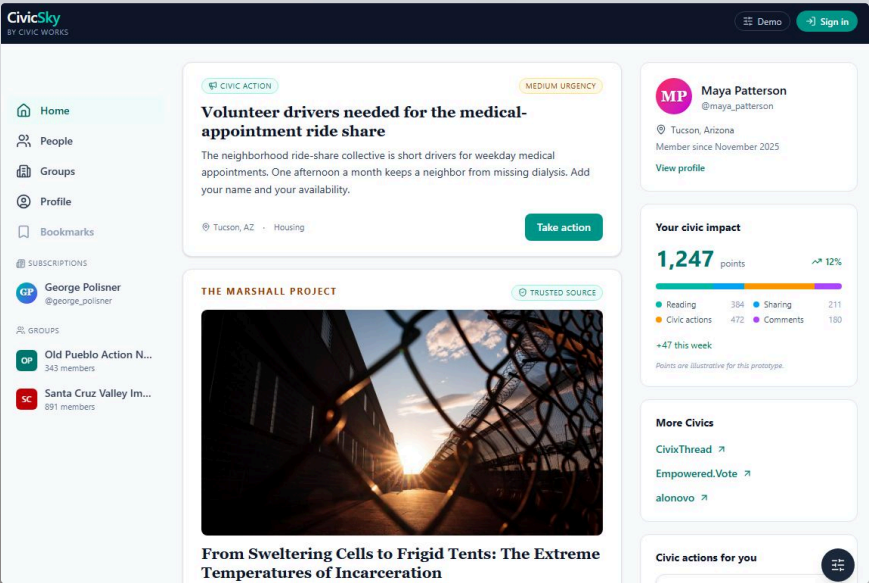




CivicSky

The civic/social layer of the open social web.

George A. Polisner, Founder | Civic Works | civicsky.civ.works

The Challenge

Polarization Crisis

Political division is now the **2nd biggest concern** for American voters, surpassing most economic and health issues.

Platforms Profit from Outrage

Every major social network optimizes engagement, and outrage is the highest-engagement signal. The incentive structure is broken by design.

Nothing Connects the Dots

Trusted writers are scattered across newsletters. Readers are trapped in algorithmic feeds with propaganda and misinformation. Reading, discussing, and acting are three separate, disconnected experiences.

Civicsky

BY CIVIC WORKS

Readers

Creators

Special Roles

Internal Admin

Demo

Sign In

Viewing as: Civircles — Small-group facilitated deliberation — bridging polarization and building consensus. [\[Phase 2: this view is a designed mockup walkthrough\]](#)

Civircles — Session in progress

Observing as: researcher / platform administrator. You are not a participant in this session.

SESSION TOPIC

Immigration enforcement and due process in our community

An invited deliberation among 13 participants. Facilitated by Civic Synthesis (AI).

Invitation criteria are set and reviewed by internal administrators. Civircles invitations consider engagement patterns including news-vetting practice, cross-perspective dialogue, and prior session quality. Specific thresholds are intentionally not published — to keep the system trustworthy, the criteria are not publicly gameable.

1. Lobby2. Active Discussion3. Synthesis4. Consensus + Action Loop5. Outcome Tracking

4 / 5

INVITED PARTICIPANTS (13)

DC

Daniel Cho

Free Civicsky reader in Tucson. Works in logistics; not an organizer. New to civic deliberation.

Invited for: sustained good-faith reading; openness to perspectives unlike his own.

DM

Dale Merrick

Third-generation rancher and small-business owner near Marana. Hires immigrant labor; wants serious enforcement. Unapologetic about both.

Invited based on: candor across disagreement; willingness to stay in hard conversations; prior session contributions.

MQ

Marisol Quintero

Rapid-response volunteer with a Tucson background. Able to handle, reason thru...

Consensus reached

Civic Synthesis (AI)

Final consensus statement

What holds: no one should be removed without a hearing, without access to counsel, and without verification of their identity and status first. On this we agree across every seat in this circle. What does not hold, and we name it plainly: we do not agree on enforcement levels, on whether there should be a legalization pathway, or on a citizenship path for DACA recipients. Participants leave this circle still disagreeing on those questions. That disagreement is not a failure of the conversation — it is the honest result of it. The due-process floor is what we can build on together now.

Civic Synthesis (AI)

Session summary

Time: 1 hour 47 minutes

Participants: 13, with 6 perspectives meaningfully present in synthesis

Vetted-news sources cited: 9

Facilitation interventions for tone: 0

Scope-disagreements preserved: 1

Civic Synthesis (AI)

Joining the cross-group consensus archive...

This is the platform's loop closing deliberation → consensus → aggregated consensus → civic action → policy.

What CivicSky Is

One place where trusted writers, neighbors who disagree, and elected officials meet, and where discussion turns into action.



Read

Short-form social posts plus long-form, paid publishing from vetted civic writers, similar to Substack but with a trust layer built in.



Deliberate

CivicCircles: AI-facilitated discussion rooms that surface common ground across the political spectrum, not echo chambers.



Act

Verified civic actions routed to the people who have the authority and responsibility to do something about them.

Trusted Authors, by Design

Our editorial commitment spans **pragmatic left, center, and pragmatic right**. No extremes. No outrage merchants, no conspiracy content, no hate. Every author is vetted before they can monetize on the platform.

This is not a moderation policy bolted on after the fact. It is the **core product promise**. Trust is the thing readers pay for, and we protect it structurally, not just through content rules.

The Editorial Commitment

- Pragmatic left represented
- Center represented
- Pragmatic right represented
- No extremes on either end
- All authors vetted before monetization

Every news link carries its credentials

A trust and bias overlay on every news source shared on CivicSky.

When anyone shares a news link, CivicSky automatically attaches a compact rating badge for the source:

- Reliability: how factual and trustworthy the outlet is
- Bias: where the outlet sits from left to right
- Who rated it: ratings come from independent third parties (such as Ad Fontes Media), never from CivicSky itself

Tap the badge to see the full rating, the rater's methodology, and similar coverage from sources across the spectrum.

Why it matters

Readers judge sources, not just headlines

Low-reliability links are labeled, not censored

The same overlay follows content wherever CivicSky reaches: our feed, shared posts, and federated networks

We don't tell people what to think. We show them where information comes from.

The screenshot displays the CivicSky interface, which provides a compact rating badge for news sources. The interface is divided into two main sections: a top section for a specific story and a bottom section for a detailed source rating.

Top Section:

- Story 1:** Daniel Cho shared a story (1 hour ago · Tucson). The story is from the **ARIZONA DESERT LEDGER**, which has a **High reliability** rating and is **Center** on the bias spectrum. The headline is "Pima County's groundwater plan, explained: who pays, who pumps, and what changes in 2027". The summary states: "The proposal would cap new agricultural wells and fund recharge basins. Farmers, developers and tribal water officials weigh in." It has 42 comments, 118 shares, and a link to "Discuss in a CivCircle".
- Story 2:** Dale Merrick shared a story (3 hours ago · Marana · via Threads). The story is from **THE VIRAL REPORT**, which has a **Low reliability** rating and is **Lean right** on the bias spectrum. The headline is "Border towns 'overrun' as new policy takes effect". A note below the headline states: "Rated low reliability by 2 of 2 independent raters. **Shown with context, not removed.** [See other coverage of this story](#)".

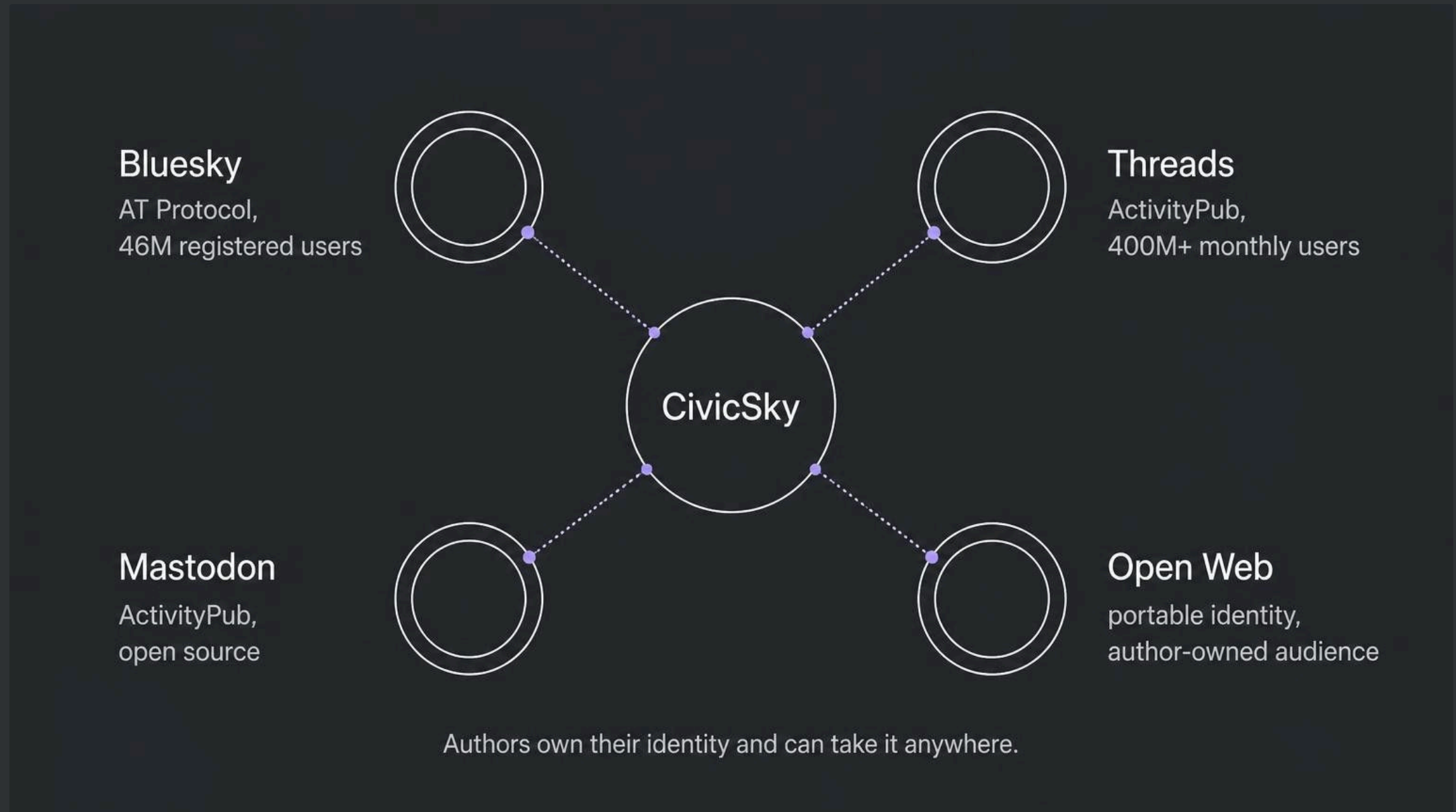
Bottom Section: SOURCE RATING (Arizona Desert Ledger)

This section provides a detailed breakdown of the source's rating:

- Reliability:** A horizontal bar chart showing ratings from Ad Fontes Media (High) and NewsGuard (Credible).
- Bias:** A horizontal bar chart showing the source's position on the spectrum from Left to Right. The source is rated as "Center".
- Raters agree:** A note stating "Raters agree: reliable reporting, close to center. How each rater scores sources".
- Same story from across the spectrum:** A list of other stories from different sources, each with its own bias rating:
 - Valley Tribune** (Farmers push back on well cap) - **Lean left**
 - Southwest Wire** (Groundwater plan clears first vote) - **Center**
 - Copper State Journal** (Who really pays for recharge) - **Lean right**

Independent and Built on Open Protocols

CivicSky speaks both major open social protocols, connecting to the full open web without being controlled by any single network.



Distribution reach on day one: Threads (400M+ monthly users) and Bluesky (46M registered users) are one follow away. No single network owns our audience, and none can take it away.

Controlled Prototype

Built Lean, Controlled Prototype

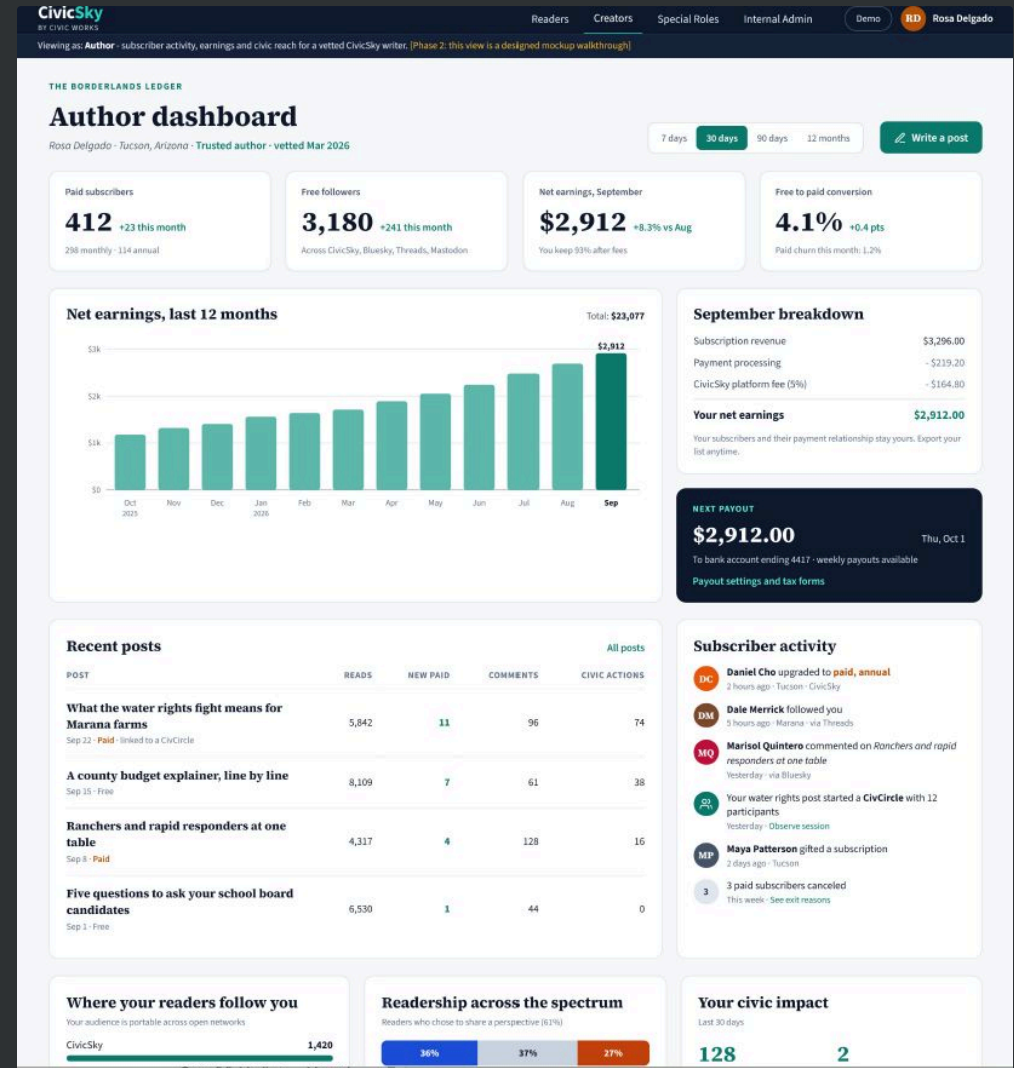
The founding team built the current prototype using AI-assisted development at near-zero cost. The live demo is at civicsky.civ.works.

What you can see today:

- Free, paid, and federated reader experience
- Paywalled long-form essays
- 7 distinct feed card types
- Full CivicCircles deliberation walkthrough

Next in Prototype

- Author publishing tools
- Media outlet accounts
- Elected official account type



The Market Is Real and Already Paying

\$45M

Substack ARR

Annualized, with 5M+ paid subscriptions and an estimated \$450M paid to writers to date.

\$30M

Beehiiv ARR

A fast-growing newsletter platform with no deliberation or civic focus, proving the publishing market is expanding.

11.9M

Make.org Participants

Deliberation tools like Pol.is and Make.org prove demand, but they are episodic with no daily reading habit and no audience.

#1

Substack Top Genre

US politics and civic writing is the top revenue genre on Substack, estimated at \$18.6M in annual platform revenue alone.

No one combines trusted content, cross-partisan deliberation, and civic action in a single product with a daily habit loop.

The Competitive Landscape

Platform	Publishing + Pay	Open Protocol	Deliberation	Civic Action
Substack / Beehiiv / Ghost	Yes	No	No	No
Leaflet / Offprint	Early, no payments	Yes	No	No
Pol.is / Make.org	No	No	Yes	No
CivicSky	Yes	Both protocols	Yes	Yes

Our moat: vetted author trust layer, CivicSpaces, elected-official account type, and a mission-lock structure that prevents a sale-and-pivot.

Business Model

Revenue Streams

Reader Subscriptions

Low platform fee to authors, keeping writers committed to the platform long-term.

Premium Tiers

Upgraded experiences for both readers and authors who want deeper tools.

Institutional Accounts

Elected officials, advocacy organizations, and newsrooms pay for verified presence and tools.

Civic Research Insights

Aggregate, privacy-preserving data for academic institutions and civic organizations.

Corporate Structure

CivicSky PBC (Public Benefit Corporation) raises capital and operates the platform. It captures upside for investors while encoding a public mission in its charter.

Civic Works 501(c)(3) holds the core IP, licenses it to the PBC, and holds a golden share that structurally prevents a sale that would gut the mission.

Roadmap to the 2028 Election



After November 2028: authors and paying subscribers stay year-round. Elections bring the spikes in new users, but the daily reading habit is the durable business.

A Lean Build Model with Real Accountability

How We Build

01

Prototype Stage

Founding team with AI-assisted development. Near-zero cost. Already shipping at civicsky.civ.works.

02

Beta Stage

Contract engineering only. No fixed payroll before product-market signals are confirmed. Preserves capital and maintains optionality.

03

Production Stage

Blended model: core hires for critical roles, contractors for scale. Triggered by milestone achievement, not a calendar date.

The Founding Team

George Polisner, Founder - Technology leadership at Oracle, HP, and Dell; California state government experience; civic organizing and deliberative democracy research.

Golda Velez, CTO (to be confirmed) - Engineering leadership with deep open-protocol experience.

Advisors to be added. We are actively recruiting civic tech and media veterans to the advisory board.

The Ask

Milestone-Based Seed Round

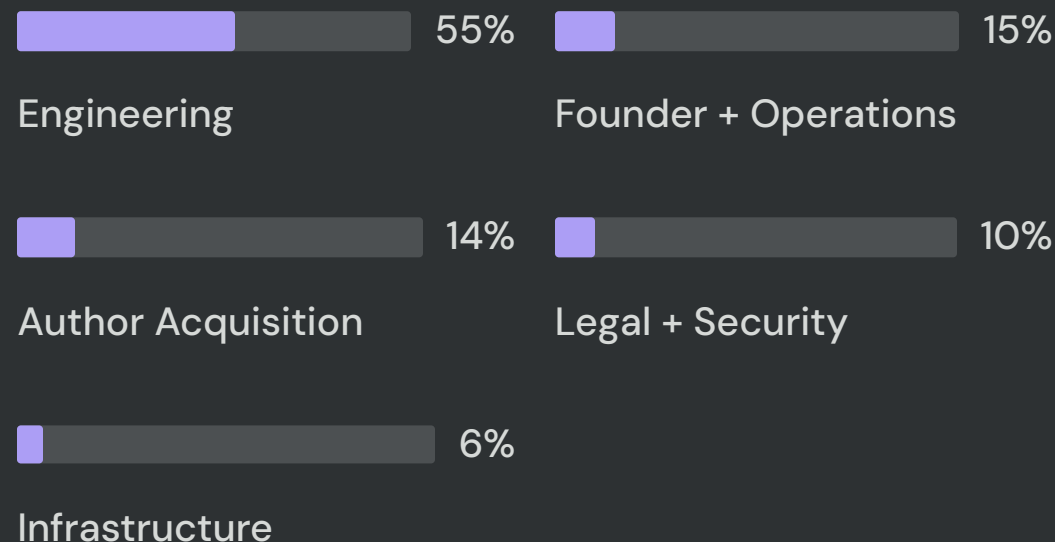
First close: \$850K - funds a 12-month contract-built beta. Deployment begins immediately on close.

Second tranche: \$2.0 - 2.5M - committed up front, released when beta milestones are hit (target: June 2027). Funds production through the 2028 election.

Beta Milestones for Tranche Release

- Federation and author payouts live
- 25+ paying authors onboarded
- 300+ paid subscribers
- 3,000 monthly active users

Use of First Close (\$850K)



Civic infrastructure that cannot be sold to be subverted.

Contact: George Polisner | civicsky.civ.works | george@civ.works